OPPORTUNITY SCANNER INDUSTRY PLAYBOOK

The 2026 Clean Energy, Facilities, and Sustainability Opportunity Playbook

A source-backed guide to public buildings, resilience programs, energy funding, implementation partners, contractors, and funded buyers.

6 lanes Facilities, grants, recipients, projects, partners, and policy	**Buyer map** Owners and implementers may differ	**30 days** A focused account plan

Built for founders and revenue teams that need credible targets, clear revenue motions, contact paths, and next actions - not a generic list of grants or contracts.

Opportunity Scanner by Opportunity Systems

Research current as of July 27, 2026. Always recheck time-sensitive official sources before acting.

The opportunity landscape

Use these lanes to separate records that imply different buyers, partners, timing, and next actions.

6 evidence lanes to investigate

- 01 **Facility plans**
- 02 **Energy grants**
- 03 **Funded owners**
- 04 **Implementation projects**
- 05 **Prime partners**
- 06 **Policy demand**

From signal to an owned revenue action

- 01 **Define outcome**
- 02 **Find funded owner**
- 03 **Identify implementer**
- 04 **Check procurement route**
- 05 **Start account plan**

These diagrams are operating maps, not a promise that every lane is open. The report explains the evidence, constraints, and qualification checks behind each route.

Updated July 27, 2026. Program status, appropriations, recipient plans, solicitations, and deadlines are time-sensitive and must be rechecked before publication and before action.

Offer and audience

This report is for energy-efficiency contractors, building-controls firms, HVAC and electrical companies, energy auditors, commissioning providers, distributed-energy companies, construction-material suppliers, engineering firms, software vendors, and business-development teams pursuing public facilities.

Conversion promise: Learn how public funding becomes a buyer, contract, subcontract, or partner route, then qualify the evidence. This report does not determine eligibility, compliance, tax treatment, bonding capacity, or likely revenue.

Executive brief

The public-sector clean-energy market is a chain: an agency establishes money or authority; a government, Tribe, district, or authority receives or budgets it; that owner defines a project; and procurement flows through a solicitation, purchasing vehicle, construction manager, utility, ESCO, or prime. A funding announcement is usually several steps from a sale.

As of July 2026, several large federal investments are in implementation rather than launch. The Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act provided $550 million for the Energy Efficiency and Conservation Block Grant program, $500 million for the State Energy Program, and $500 million for Renew America's Schools. DOE reports that Renew America's Schools has invested $372.5 million across approximately 410 facilities in 36 states. GSA's Inflation Reduction Act authority included $2.15 billion for low-embodied-carbon materials, $975 million for emerging and sustainable technologies, and $250 million for high-performance green buildings; official GSA materials state that the first two funding pools expire September 30, 2026. Those figures describe authorized or program-level funding, not open addressable revenue.

The opportunity is downstream. Awards reveal public owners; school portfolios reveal buildings and partners; GSA projects can reveal primes and specifications; and performance contracts route vendors through ESCOs. Capital plans remain planning signals until budget, scope, authority, and procurement path are verified.

Opportunity Scanner should preserve those distinctions. Every result needs a source date, evidence type, named target, revenue motion, contact path, status, and one next validation. The product's value is not saying that money exists. It is showing who can spend it, what evidence supports the route, and what to do next.

State of the market: five trends that change the sales motion

1. Implementation records now matter more than headline funding totals

DOE's infrastructure program inventory lists broad statutory investments, including $500 million for the State Energy Program. Its Winter 2025 progress report said more than $200 million in EECBG formula funding had been awarded to 443 communities and $172.4 million had been awarded through 36 State Energy Program revolving-loan-fund awards at that reporting point. These are useful indicators that money had moved to recipients, but the report is a snapshot, not a July 2026 balance sheet.

Business implication: Search recipient plans, board approvals, procurement portals, and active notices. Label the award `funding-to-buyer evidence`, record its period, and require a downstream implementation check.

2. Public-school facilities show both demand and competition

DOE reports that the first Renew America's Schools round drew more than 1,000 concept papers totaling nearly $5.5 billion in requests, while the round ultimately identified 24 selectees for $178 million. For the 2024 round, 16 selectees were invited into cooperative agreements ranging from $7.5 million to $15 million, with portfolios covering 320 facilities. DOE's current program page reports $372.5 million invested across about 410 facilities in 36 states through the program to date.

Business implication: A selected district is not an unrestricted vendor lead. Capture the portfolio, scope, and partners; connect them to district procurement and board records; promote only when a purchasing path appears.

3. Performance contracting creates a channel market

DOE defines a federal energy savings performance contract as a partnership in which an energy service company audits, designs, constructs, and arranges financing for improvements, with guaranteed savings used to pay for the project. Measurement and verification is mandatory. DOE's Generation 4 indefinite-delivery, indefinite-quantity vehicle was awarded to 20 ESCOs in 2023. The ordering guide states a $5 billion maximum ceiling for each contract, a five-year base plus five-year option, and task-order performance periods of up to 25 years under the governing authority.

The ceiling is capacity, not spending, and must not be summed as market size. Many controls, equipment, construction, commissioning, and distributed-energy firms should pursue Sell to Award Recipient or Channel / Distributor Motion through a Gen4 ESCO. Explain the relevant energy conservation measure, performance evidence, and geography.

4. Federal construction funding creates material and prime-contractor routes

GSA received $3.375 billion through three Inflation Reduction Act facilities provisions: $2.15 billion for low-embodied-carbon materials, $975 million for emerging and sustainable technologies, and $250 million for high-performance green buildings. GSA project materials identify asphalt, concrete, glass, and steel among the targeted material categories. GSA's published funding presentation states that the low-embodied-carbon and emerging-technology funds expire September 30, 2026, while the high-performance-green-building funds expire September 30, 2031.

Business implication: Expiration may increase urgency but does not guarantee a solicitation or remaining balance. Material and technology vendors should find specifications, documentation requirements, construction managers, test beds, and supplier packages.

5. Compliance and performance evidence shape accessibility

Federal, state, and local projects can carry prevailing-wage, Build America Buy America, Buy American, environmental review, bonding, insurance, cybersecurity, safety, and reporting obligations. Which rules apply depends on the funding source, agreement, project, and contract. DOE's EECBG public Q&A, for example, states that NEPA, Davis-Bacon, and Build America Buy America apply to EECBG competitive grants, while the details must be resolved with the award and project officer.

Business implication: Treat compliance as a qualification field. Unknown requirements create validation tasks. Domestic manufacture alone does not prove compliance with the applicable definition, component test, waiver, and clause.

Seven opportunity lanes

Lane	What the signal proves	Typical target	Revenue motion	First validation
Active public-facility procurement	A public buyer has published a current purchasing event	Agency, city, county, authority, district	Sell to Agency	Notice status, scope, deadline, vehicle, bidder requirements
Funded state or local implementation	A government recipient has funds or financing authority for an approved purpose	State energy office, locality, public authority	Sell to Funded Buyer	Local project, budget, period, procurement calendar
School and campus portfolios	A district or consortium has identified facility work	LEA, higher-education system, consortium lead	Sell to Funded Buyer; Partner with Recipient	Named buildings, phase, partner roles, district purchasing route
Federal construction and modernization	A federal property project or program includes relevant work	GSA region, agency, construction manager, prime	Sell to Agency; Sell to Award Recipient	Project status, prime, package, specification, acquisition route
ESPC and utility channels	An owner is using savings-backed or utility-led delivery	ESCO, utility, agency energy manager	Channel / Distributor Motion; Sell to Award Recipient	Vehicle holder, task order, ECM fit, M&V role
Direct assistance and demonstrations	A live notice accepts eligible applicants or teams	Agency program office, lab, consortium	Direct Apply; Partner with Recipient	Eligibility, deadline, cost share, technology readiness, award type
Capital-plan and policy signals	An owner has documented need, targets, audits, or planned capital work	Facilities director, energy office, public works	Monitor Policy; Research Only	Adopted budget, funding source, procurement trigger, timing

These lanes should not be collapsed. A federal grant page and a local bid can concern the same building but represent different stages, contacts, and actions.

Funding-to-buyer route map

Route A: Formula or competitive award to public recipient

Identify the legal recipient and approved activity, then inspect its energy strategy, grant acceptance, purchasing portal, and capital plan. The contact path is the project owner or procurement office, not the federal press contact.

Promote when: the project is specific, timing is current, the offer fits, and a purchasing route is visible.

Hold when: the record is only an allocation, the recipient has not selected a project, or the period and remaining balance are unknown.

Route B: Portfolio award to district or consortium

Capture the consortium lead, districts, facilities, partners, federal share, and phase. Search board packets and procurement notices independently; a named partner may already own part of delivery.

Promote when: the district has approved implementation, released a package, or identified a vendor-engagement route.

Hold when: the organization is a prize winner but not a cooperative-agreement selectee, or scope is still conceptual.

Route C: Federal project to prime and supplier

Identify the property, region, phase, prime, and requirement. Search SAM.gov for the current notice and USAspending for history. Confirm material documentation or subcontract-package requirements.

Promote when: a current prime, package, source-sought notice, or solicitation exists.

Hold when: the source is an old project announcement with no evidence of an open package.

Route D: ESPC owner to ESCO project team

Match the offer to a specific energy conservation measure and identify qualified ESCOs and awarded projects in the geography. Outreach should establish project-team fit, not bypass the vehicle.

Promote when: the ESCO serves the geography and agency, the product supports measurable performance, and a project or partner-intake route is identifiable.

Hold when: the only evidence is presence on the Gen4 holder list.

Qualification model: score the route, then apply gates

Score each factor from 0 to 2. A total is useful only after the gates below are applied.

Factor	0	1	2
Offer fit	Keyword overlap only	Plausible system or service fit	Exact scope, equipment, material, or use-case fit
Evidence status	Historical or unclear	Current plan, award, or forecast	Active notice, approved project, or current partner intake
Funding clarity	Headline total only	Recipient and purpose known	Project budget, period, and allowable scope verified
Buyer clarity	No target	Organization named	Purchasing owner or prime identified
Route clarity	Unknown	Likely route	Confirmed vehicle, portal, package, or solicitation

Factor	0	1	2
Timing	Expired or undated	Future window or multi-year phase	Current deadline or near-term procurement milestone
Readiness	Material gaps	Gaps can be closed	Required geography, capacity, registrations, and evidence in place
Contact path	Generic inbox only	Relevant office	Source-native contact or documented vendor route

Suggested labels: 13-16 High Actionability; 8-12 Medium Actionability; 0-7 Low Actionability. This is a triage model, not a probability of award.

Hard gates:

- Do not label High if the notice is expired, canceled, or only anticipated.
- Do not label High if the buyer, prime, or procurement route is unknown.
- Do not recommend Direct Apply unless applicant eligibility is verified from the current notice.
- Do not claim domestic-content, wage, code, bonding, or environmental compliance from marketing copy alone.
- Do not treat an IDIQ ceiling, program authorization, allocation, tax credit, or loan authority as spendable contract value.
- Do not expose a personal contact unless it is source-native and relevant to the purchasing route.

Source-to-action matrix

Source	Best question	Extract	Do not infer	Next action
SAM.gov Contract Opportunities	What federal purchasing event is active?	Notice ID, type, agency, NAICS/PSC, dates, contact	Award likelihood or eligibility	Read attachments and create bid/no-bid task
USAspending	Who received related federal awards?	Recipient, agency, amount, period, description, award ID	Open demand or remaining funds	Trace recipient, incumbent, and related notice
DOE SCEP program and recipient pages	Which public entities received implementation support?	Recipient, program, amount, phase, facilities	Direct vendor access	Search recipient procurement and approvals
State energy-office and locality sites	What project will the recipient execute?	Plan, subaward, RFP, board action, owner	Federal endorsement of a vendor	Confirm budget and procurement route
School board and district procurement	Which buildings and packages are moving?	Agenda, award, solicitation, facilities plan	That every funded school is buying now	Contact procurement or named project lead
GSA project and IRA pages	Which federal facilities and categories are implicated?	Property, material, technology, phase	Unobligated balance or open package	Find SAM notice, prime, region, specification
DOE FEMP ESPC pages	Which ESCO channel can deliver the work?	Holder, contact, awarded project, guidance	Available subcontract or agency order	Prepare ECM-specific partner outreach
Grants.gov / agency exchange	Is direct assistance currently open?	Notice, eligibility, award type, deadline, cost share	Procurement revenue	Decide apply, team, monitor, or reject
Capital improvement plans	What need may become funded?	Facility, year, estimate, funding source	Approved procurement	Track budget adoption and solicitation trigger

How to use Opportunity Scanner for this market

1. Build the company profile

Record exact systems, services, product standards, project sizes, states served, self-performance versus partner work, union or prevailing-wage capability, bonding and insurance limits, past performance, contract vehicles, commissioning or M&V capability, domestic-manufacturing facts, and target facility types. Unknowns become tasks.

2. Search by asset and problem, not only by "clean energy"

Use terms such as chiller, boiler, building automation, switchgear, lighting, envelope, heat recovery, water conservation, microgrid, commissioning, energy audit, environmental product declaration, low-embodied-carbon concrete, school modernization, and central plant. Pair them with NAICS, product service codes, agencies, geographies, and facility types.

3. Normalize every signal

Minimum fields: evidence type; source URL; source publication date; data or project period; named target; facility or geography; relevant scope; funding or contract amount with definition; status; revenue motion; contact path; constraint; next action; recheck date.

4. Build the Opportunity Action Table

Each row should state what happened, why it fits, who can buy or partner, the route, the first unresolved fact, action owner, and recheck date.

5. Preserve rejected and monitor records

An expired funding notice can explain a recipient's project but should not remain in an active pipeline. A capital plan may be worth monitoring. Record the rejection or monitor reason so the same weak lead is not rediscovered every week.

Worked example: controls contractor pursuing school facilities

Company: A regional controls integrator serves K-12 facilities and subcontracts under mechanical projects.

Evidence chain: DOE names a Renew America's Schools consortium whose scope includes controls and HVAC. A district approves grant acceptance but has no active controls solicitation; construction-manager selection is scheduled.

Interpretation: DOE proves selection, not an open buy. Board action improves confidence; the construction-manager milestone identifies the likely channel.

Revenue motion: Partner with Recipient initially; change to Sell to Award Recipient when the construction manager is selected.

Contact path: District facilities lead for scope validation and procurement office for process; later, the selected construction manager's supplier or subcontractor intake.

Next action: Confirm whether controls are owner-furnished, part of a mechanical package, or separately bid.

30-day action plan

Days 1-5: Define the sellable wedge

Choose two facility types and three scopes. Complete readiness, codes, geography, and preferred agency, subcontract, ESCO, distributor, or funded-buyer route.

Days 6-10: Build the evidence set

Collect 20 records across notices, recipients, school portfolios, GSA projects, ESCOs, and capital plans. Preserve URLs, dates, status, amount definitions, and reject keyword-only matches.

Days 11-15: Trace funding downstream

Trace recipient records through approvals, procurement, plans, and partners. For federal projects, identify the acquisition office or prime. Reduce to ten named routes.

Days 16-20: Score and gate

Apply the model; verify status, restrictions, periods, and registrations. Assign a label. Keep no more than five active pursuits without a concrete next action.

Days 21-25: Create route-specific outreach

Prepare capability variants for owners, ESCOs, and primes. Refer to verified scope, explain the company's role, and ask one fit question. Never imply inside information or guaranteed purchasing.

Days 26-30: Move or close every row

Log responses, source-native contacts, tasks, and recheck dates. Close unsupported rows and focus the next scan on patterns that produced movement.

Limits and warnings

- This report is not legal, tax, engineering, procurement, grant, labor, environmental, or compliance advice.
- Program authorizations and IDIQ ceilings are not market size, obligations, available balances, or vendor revenue.
- A recipient may use internal staff, an existing cooperative contract, a utility, an ESCO, a construction manager, or a previously selected vendor.
- Federal award descriptions can be broad, lag implementation, and change through amendments.
- Selectee, winner, applicant, recipient, subrecipient, prime, and subcontractor are not interchangeable.
- Appropriation expiration does not prove an open solicitation or available funding.
- USAspending records are historical award evidence and may be revised; reconcile material claims to the agency or notice.
- Local capital plans may be proposed, unfunded, deferred, or amended.
- Verify all live opportunities and attachments on the official source immediately before action.

Evidence ledger

Claim or use	Official primary source	Period / retrieval	Caveat
DOE infrastructure program funding inventory	DOE, Infrastructure Programs at Department of Energy	Retrieved 2026-07-11	Statutory or program amounts; not open procurement or remaining balance.
EECBG, SEP, and revolving-loan-fund implementation snapshot	DOE, Winter 2025 Infrastructure Progress Report	Winter 2025; retrieved 2026-07-11	Point-in-time progress; do not present as July 2026 totals.
SCEP recipient-led program structure	DOE, Office of State and Community Energy Programs	Retrieved 2026-07-11	Program overview; recipient plans govern implementation.
EECBG compliance and recipient responsibility context	DOE, Weekly Responses to Public Questions About EECBG	Questions mainly 2023-2024; retrieved 2026-07-11	Q&A is contextual; current award terms and project officer control.
Renew America's Schools program total and facility reach	DOE, Renew America's Schools	Retrieved 2026-07-11	Program-to-date figures; not proof of active procurement at every facility.
First-round school demand and selectees	DOE, Renew America's Schools Grant 2022-23	2022-2023 round; retrieved 2026-07-11	Closed competition; use as demand and recipient evidence only.
2024 school selectees and portfolio structure	DOE, 2024 Renew America's Schools Prize and Grant	Selectees announced 2024; retrieved 2026-07-11	Selection and cooperative-agreement route do not equal vendor solicitation.
Federal ESPC model and requirements	DOE FEMP, About Federal Energy Savings Performance Contracts	Retrieved 2026-07-11	General vehicle model; task-order terms govern each project.
Gen4 ESCO holder list	DOE FEMP, ESPC Generation 4 IDIQ Energy Service Companies	Contracts awarded 2023; retrieved 2026-07-11	Holder status does not prove an available subcontract.

Claim or use	Official primary source	Period / retrieval	Caveat
Gen4 ceiling and ordering structure	DOE FEMP, Gen4 ESPC Ordering Guide	2024 guide; retrieved 2026-07-11	$5 billion is the ceiling for each contract, not spending or market size.
ESPC measurement and verification	DOE FEMP, Measurement and Verification for Federal ESPCs	Retrieved 2026-07-11	Project-specific M&V is defined in the task order.
GSA facilities funding categories and expiration periods	GSA, Inflation Reduction Act PBS Customer Forum update	Published 2024; retrieved 2026-07-11	Funding authority and expiration dates do not show unobligated balances.
GSA low-embodied-carbon material categories	GSA, Low-Embodied Carbon Projects Industry Fact Sheet	Current as of 2023-11-03; retrieved 2026-07-11	Project plan may have changed; verify current solicitation specifications.
Current federal contract opportunities	U.S. General Services Administration, SAM.gov Contract Opportunities	Live source; retrieved 2026-07-11	Search result is not a substitute for the notice and attachments.
Federal award and recipient history	U.S. Department of the Treasury, USAspending.gov	Live database; retrieved 2026-07-11	Historical award evidence; records can be revised and do not prove open demand.

Put this guide to work

Opportunity Scanner reads your company website, finds source-backed public-sector signals, and translates them into target organizations, revenue motions, contact paths, and next actions.

Run a free company scan at opportunityscanner.ai

Recheck official sources before any outreach, application, registration, or bid decision.